

Complaining about AI's impact on the environment from their 100% environmentally friendly social media that totally doesn't provide data to AI companies from their totally farm to table homegrown electronic device. /s

Posted by u/MelodicWallaby4476 • 0 points • 12 comments

I seriously hate the environmental arguments against AI because it is just a weak straw to grasp at as an argument that, more often than not, uses falsified information. There are so many benefits to the world thanks to the introduction of AI including energy reform and usage in environmental science. There are actual arguments that can be made against specific aspects of AI's integration into society, but using this as your big "Oh, No, bad AI" immediately shows you don't care about the environment and only want to rage against AI. If you care about the environment, go after the actual issues affecting the world. If you don't like AI, actually learn about real issues and weigh them against the benefits.

Comments

u/WrappedInChrome • 1 points • 2025-06-17 15:44 UTC

Can't criticize the literal gigawatts of energy consumption of AI companies if you own technology... of course if you don't you also can't advocate for saving the planet... so basically you just want everyone to shut up? But who will be left to give you the validation you apparently need so bad?

u/Odd-Culture-1238 • 2 points • 2025-06-18 00:42 UTC

It would have taken more energy to have it drawn by a human on a tablet.

u/WrappedInChrome • 0 points • 2025-06-18 02:00 UTC

lol, that's literally untrue. That is remarkably untrue. Generating an AI image takes about 2,282 joules of energy. That is HOURS of a tablet. If you generate 3 images you've used more energy than a tablet would use running at full power for a full 24 hour time period.

Why would you say something so silly when it's so easy to check?

u/Scam_Altman • 2 points • 2025-06-18 04:39 UTC

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The claim that generating an AI image consumes **2,282 joules** (or **~0.63 watt-hours**) and that creating three images exceeds a tablet's 24-hour energy use is **highly misleading or incorrect**. Let's break it down:

1. **AI Image Generation Energy Use**

- The oft-cited **2,282 joules** figure comes from a **2023 study** (Luccioni et al.), but this refers to generating an image on a **high-end GPU** (e.g., Nvidia A100) under specific conditions.
- **Real-world usage is typically lower**.

- Optimized models (like Stable Diffusion on consumer hardware) use **far less energy** (~100-500 joules/image).
- Cloud-based services may have overhead, but efficiencies (batch processing, shared resources) reduce per-image costs.
- For comparison: **0.63 watt-hours (Wh)** is roughly the energy of **charging a smartphone** for ~5 minutes.

2. **Tablet Energy Consumption**

- A typical tablet (e.g., iPad) uses **5-10 watts** under load.
- Over **24 hours**, that's **120-240 watt-hours** (not accounting for idle/sleep modes).
- **3 AI images at 2,282 joules each** = **6,846 joules** or **~1.9 watt-hours**—nowhere near a tablet's 24-hour consumption.

3. **Why the Original Claim is Wrong**

- The math assumes **worst-case AI energy use** while ignoring **real-world tablet usage**.
- Even if AI energy use were accurate, **1.9 Wh vs. 120+ Wh** is off by a factor of **60+**.

4. **Context Matters**

- AI image generation **can** be energy-intensive, but comparisons should be fair:
- **1 AI image** $\approx$ **5-10 minutes of tablet use** (not hours).
- **Cloud efficiency**: Data centers often use renewable energy, offsetting carbon impact.

5. **Conclusion**

The original claim exaggerates AI energy use by **orders of magnitude**. While AI has a non-negligible footprint, it's not "3 images = 24 tablet-hours." Accurate estimates matter in these debates.

Sources:

- Luccioni et al. (2023) "Energy Usage of Stable Diffusion" ([arXiv](https://arxiv.org/abs/2301.04203))
- U.S. DOE on device energy use ([EnergyStar](https://www.energystar.gov/))

Would you like help finding more precise comparisons?

u/WrappedInChrome • 0 points • 2025-06-18 05:03 UTC

I'm not reading that stupid shit.

My God, you scrubs can't even talk for yourself anymore.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-08-28 11:36 UTC

[removed]

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-08-28 11:36 UTC

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Private information includes names, recognizable profile pictures, social media usernames, other subreddits, and URLs. Failure to do this will result in your post being removed by the Mod team

and possible further action.

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit] (/message/compose/?to=/r/aiwars) if you have any questions or concerns.

u/MelodicWallaby4476 • 1 points • 2025-06-18 13:16 UTC

Even if it is generated, it's better than regurgitating and defending provably incorrect claims and not taking a modicum of effort to learn anything from cited sources you are provided.

u/Odd-Culture-1238 • 2 points • 2025-06-18 12:00 UTC

If you want your own data, you could run an AI locally and look in real time how much the battery drops.

u/Scam_Altman • 2 points • 2025-06-17 22:44 UTC

>Can't criticize the literal gigawatts of energy consumption of AI companies if you own technology...

The problem here is that that power produces more output productivity by an order of magnitude compared to traditional tools which also consume power. If I can write an article and generate a title image in a fraction of a time it would take to do it all typing manually and with traditional graphic design, you have a net positive impact on the environment.

>of course if you don't you also can't advocate for saving the planet... so basically you just want everyone to shut up? But who will be left to give you the validation you apparently need so bad?

No. The problem here is that people are being deliberately disingenuous and dishonest. Go look up the impact of the meat industry on the environment in terms of water consumption, electricity use, and greenhouse emissions. I'll wait.

If you're chomping down on a burger while bitching about the impact of AI on the environment, then the answer is yes. Shut your hypocrite mouth the fuck up you dumb little bitch. You are actively participating in a horrific deliberate action that is actively destroying the planet because you feel entitled to the little dopamine rush you get from eating meat derived from the mass torture of sentient life. Nobody with that level of cognitive dissonance is capable of arguing in good faith, and I feel zero guilt calling them out as the soulless ghouls that they are.

If you care about the AI industry and don't give a fuck about the meat industry, I can guarantee you are a "ban/regulate everything I don't like, but make special exceptions for the things I do like" kind of person. Aka, an intellectually dishonest authoritarian scumbag trying to wrap themselves in a fake shroud of environmentalism to legitimize their narcissism. Prove me wrong.

u/WrappedInChrome • -1 points • 2025-06-18 02:01 UTC

It's wild that you just compared farming to AI image generation- as if the production of food is on par with generating images with an online service.

u/Scam_Altman • 1 points • 2025-06-18 02:14 UTC

There's nothing wild about it. The meat industry as it exists is unnecessary. You could tax meat at 1000%, tomorrow and nobody would starve to death. You're just such an ignorant, self centered, brain damaged hypocrite that you think "hurr durr it's food so it's necessary" is a legitimate argument, when the reality is that the meat industry contributes more to world hunger than it does feeding people. Meat is a luxury.

And the fact that I have to explain this to you is why absolutely nobody should take anything you have to say about the environment seriously. You very obviously do not give a fuck about the environment unless it's helping you win a superficial argument.

I'll patiently wait for your rebuttal but we both know how this ends.

u/MelodicWallaby4476 • 1 points • 2025-06-17 21:55 UTC

I don't need validation, I originally posted this to a reddit focused on "Irony" because I felt it fit and wanted to share. I cross-posted here because I felt the discussion warranted it. Beyond that, I also wanted to share an ecological message about toxicity in the art industry, which I also included a comment providing a number of links for reading on the matter in a comment. Although in this specific instance, I did admittedly mock the original user's action in the title due to the fact that I viewed it like criticizing someone driving a 15mpg truck while you yourself are idling in a 10mpg truck. You can criticize, sure, but it is entirely hypocritical if your point is rendered moot by your own present action.

u/WrappedInChrome • 1 points • 2025-06-18 02:04 UTC

Meta's AI BY ITSELF consumes 12 gigawatts of power. That is enough energy to sustain 9 to 12 MILLION homes. So no... it's more like criticizing a 15mpg truck while consuming a teaspoon of gas every 6 months.

I don't think you realize the true scale of how much power these models consume- but all of them combined consume 72% as much as EVERY SINGLE HOME IN AMERICA... combined.

u/Scam_Altman • 2 points • 2025-06-18 04:31 UTC

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1. Meta's Total Energy Consumption vs. AI-Specific Usage

- Meta's **total data center electricity consumption** in 2023 was **14,975,435 MWh** (megawatt-hours), a 34% increase from the previous year, driven largely by AI expansion .

- This translates to an **average power draw of ~1.71 GW** (14,975,435 MWh ÷ 8,760 hours/year).

- **AI workloads** are a significant contributor but do not account for 100% of this usage (e.g., non-AI cloud services, networking, and cooling are included) .

- The **12 GW claim** would imply Meta's AI consumes **7×** more power than Meta's entire global data center fleet, which is inconsistent with reported figures.

**2. Industry-Wide AI Energy Trends

- **Global data centers** (all companies combined) consumed **~4.4%** of U.S. electricity in 2023 (~176 TWh), with AI projected to reach **49%** of data center power by 2025 .

- Even at this scale, AI's **total** power demand is estimated at **23 GW globally** by 2025 —far below the 12 GW attributed to Meta alone .

- Training a model like **GPT-4** required **50 GWh** (equivalent to ~5.7 MW over a year), while **inference** (daily queries) dominates long-term energy use . Meta's Llama models are likely less intensive than OpenAI's largest systems .

3. Home Energy Comparisons

- The claim that **12 GW powers 9–12 million homes** assumes **~1–1.3 kW/home**, which aligns with U.S. averages . However:
- Meta's **actual** ~1.71 GW average could power **~1.3–1.7 million homes**—still substantial, but orders of magnitude lower than the claim.
- For context, **all U.S. data centers** are projected to reach **6.7–12% of national electricity use by 2028** (325–580 TWh), with AI as the primary driver .

4. Meta's Efficiency Efforts

- Meta reports **100% renewable energy** for its operations via PPAs and RECs, with a **PUE of 1.08** (near-optimal efficiency) .
- It is testing **hydrogenated vegetable oil (HVO)** for backup generators and **dry cooling** to reduce water use .
- While these measures mitigate environmental impact, the **absolute growth in energy demand** remains a concern, especially as AI inference scales .

>I don't think you realize the true scale of how much power these models consume- but all of them combined consume 72% as much as EVERY SINGLE HOME IN AMERICA... combined.

Shut the fuck up you lying piece of shit. Stop wasting my time forcing me to debunk every single one of your posts. Every single thing you say is a lie. This shit needs to be a banable offense. The only thing that comes up when you search "12 gigawatts meta ai" is their renewable energy portfolio.

<https://www.csis.org/analysis/electricity-supply-bottleneck-us-ai-dominance>

>The basic reality of a surge in data center–based electricity demand has been confirmed by a wide range of work from the private sector, civil society, and national labs. Recent estimates from the Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory (LBNL) place electricity consumption by data centers at 176 terawatt-hours (TWh) in 2023, representing 4.4 percent of total U.S. electricity demand.

<https://css.umich.edu/publications/factsheets/built-environment/residential-buildings-factsheet>

>Electricity consumption increased 14-fold from 1950 to 2022. In 2022, the residential sector used 1.42T kWh of electricity, 35% of U.S. total electricity use.11

u/MelodicWallaby4476 • 1 points • 2025-06-18 02:52 UTC

Okay, I feel you are overly outraged and lack a deeper understanding of issues, so I am willing to talk this out as I have already amassed quite a great deal of links and information regarding these subjects with too many others.

1) Please provide a reputable link for this information. If you can do this, I will gladly read the

information and concede any points in which I am wrong. However, I will also scrutinize the details and point out any inconsistencies with your claims.

2) I have read information directly related to Meta which detailed it's data centers as a whole use an energy estimate close to what you have stated, however this does not apply to AI usage singularly as data centers are a shared resource used across numerous industries, thus making your claim "Meta's AI BY ITSELF consumes 12 gigawatts of power" demonstrably false.

[<https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/meta-data-center-electricity-consumption-hits-14975gwh-leased-data-center-use-nearly-doubles/>]

(<https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/meta-data-center-electricity-consumption-hits-14975gwh-leased-data-center-use-nearly-doubles/>)

3) AI infrastructure is currently making headway into massive energy reforms and ecological research which will in turn be a long term benefit to our society though we may pay in the short term.

[<https://www.iea.org/reports/energy-and-ai/ai-and-climate-change>]

(<https://www.iea.org/reports/energy-and-ai/ai-and-climate-change>)

[[https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2024-](https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2024-04/AI%20EO%20Report%20Section%205.2g%28i%29_043024.pdf)

[04/AI%20EO%20Report%20Section%205.2g%28i%29_043024.pdf](https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2024-04/AI%20EO%20Report%20Section%205.2g%28i%29_043024.pdf)]

([https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2024-](https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2024-04/AI%20EO%20Report%20Section%205.2g%28i%29_043024.pdf)

[04/AI%20EO%20Report%20Section%205.2g%28i%29_043024.pdf](https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2024-04/AI%20EO%20Report%20Section%205.2g%28i%29_043024.pdf))

4) AI does have serious impacts on the environment, but in comparison to the art industry as a whole, which this post is about, it is one of the least waste causing and energy intensive processes when weighed exclusively against each other in similar mediums.

This is easily provable by downloading a local model onto your computer, generating an image, and calculating the energy usage (which is an absolutely trivial amount) vs the amount of energy you would have taken to draw/paint that yourself (factoring in all aspects including room lighting, potential digital tools used or waste produced if using a physical medium, and physical exertion) measured over the course of time. I can generate a decent image on a local diffusion model within seconds while using less than 1% of my mid-range laptop's battery when a similar image would take me days to make.

This does not even factor in the cost of usage vs production which goes deeper as time itself has an intrinsic value to which AI uses barely any time to produce a result and allows you to perform other tasks beyond just the art (which is where I commonly use it while I am working my job).

u/WrappedInChrome • 1 points • 2025-06-18 04:24 UTC

I'm not reading all that. I genuinely don't care enough for any of that.

u/ns2500 • 1 points • 2026-03-30 22:19 UTC

He proved you wrong that's really embarrassing coming from the guy saying you can't speak for yourself. Idiot.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-31 15:14 UTC

[removed]

u/cybenz • 1 points • 2025-10-19 19:53 UTC

I absolutely adore how even AI would be more willing to think and discuss a topic than you. "My opinion is right and I don't care what anyone says". I can see why you hate AI - you're light years away from being as intelligent as it is

u/WrappedInChrome • 1 points • 2025-10-20 01:32 UTC

lol, ai 'thinking'. That's adorable.

AI is required to engage with dipshits... I'm not. I'm glad you found a friend though, even if it is make believe.

u/cybenz

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points

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2025-10-20 03:03 UTC

I know AI doesn't actually think. That's my whole point. Bravo.

u/MelodicWallaby4476 • 1 points • 2025-06-18 12:38 UTC

Okay, so you don't actually know anything and don't care to learn but you feel your oh so passionate but ultimately fallacious personal beliefs should be espoused as fact.

Listen, I am not saying that you have to be pro-ai, but in this post I am saying that being anti-ai art while simultaneously being pro-art solely on the terms of ecological impact is inherently illogical and hypocritical.

There are good reasons that you could be anti-ai if you'd actually take time to learn them, this is not one.

u/Moonshine_Brew • 2 points • 2025-06-18 08:50 UTC

Wait, so you go to a reddit made specifically for discussing this shit and then when someone comes with actual proven claims, including links to the proof you just go "nah man"?

Why are you even here?

Your only effect on the world right now is giving "ai-bros" fuel to discredit actually valid criticism by "antis".